Eville & Jones wins five-year FSA contract

VETERINARY public health company Eville & Jones (E&J) has signed a five-year contract with the Food Standards Agency (FSA) to provide veterinary, compliance and public health solutions to the food industry in England and Wales, from 31 March 2025.

Describing itself as the UK's largest provider of veterinary public health services, E&J says it is delighted to have been awarded the maximum contract for a single provider, representing 80 per cent of the coverage across England and Wales.

The company says the contract continues its longstanding relationship with the FSA to protect animal welfare and ensure food is safe to eat.

CEO Charles Hartwell (pictured) said: 'I am delighted to announce that the FSA has recognised our capabilities by awarding us the maximum possible single supplier allocation of seven of the nine contract lots...This significant achievement underscores the FSA's confidence in our ability to support them in upholding animal welfare and food safety standards.'

Phil Marshall, CEO of Phenna, which acquired E&J in 2023, added: 'We look forward to continuing our relationship with the FSA in upholding animal welfare and food safety standards over the next five years.'

E&J, Century House, 1275 Century Way, Thorpe Park, Leeds LS15 8ZB, 0113 2840400. https://eandj.co.uk/

100th cancer patient treated by Bristol Vet Specialists' linear accelerator

BRISTOL Vet Specialists' linear accelerator has treated 100 patients since the hospital opened a year ago.

The Elekta Infinity linear accelerator, which the practice says is the only one of its kind for pets in England, enables the hospital to offer image-guided radiation treatments for cancer in cats and dogs – meaning fewer, shorter sessions, fewer side effects and improved outcomes for the animal.

Delphine Holopherne-Doran, clinical director, said: 'We have invested in this state-of-the-art technology to bring cancer treatment in pets to the next level... it allows us to offer advanced image-guided treatments; for example, intensity-modulated or stereotactic radiation therapy. The advantage of these treatments is that high dose rates of focused beams are delivered with high precision over a shortened treatment course, with greater safety for the patient's healthy tissue.

'It has now drawn many tumours into the realm of treatability, it is improving the quality of life for patients, and it is making it easier for owners to manage their pet's treatment and aftercare.'

Based at Central Park, Avonmouth, Bristol Vet Specialists is open for emergencies in all disciplines every hour of every day of the year.

Bristol Vet Specialists, Unit 10, More Plus, Central Park, Madison Way, Severn Beach, Bristol BS35 4ER, telephone 01275 838473. www.bristolvetspecialists.co.uk

GROWING GLOBAL PET GROOMING MARKET

The global dog grooming products market is projected to exceed US$ 10 billion by 2030, according to a report published by Horizon Databook.

Market research company Grand View Research, which summarised the report, says that pet ownership rates have surged particularly in countries where disposable incomes are high. It adds that the view of pets as family members has led to a pet parenting trend where pet owners are more conscious of the need to provide specialised care, including skin and coat maintenance. This has driven demand for products that address specific skin conditions, improve coat health and enhance pets' overall appearance and comfort.

There is also a demand for health-promoting products leading owners to prioritise products that are ecofriendly and cruelty free, it says.

https://bit.ly/40nOMux

RECORD YEAR FOR ANIMAL POISON LINE

With more than 14,000 calls received last year, 2024 was a record year for the Animal Poison Line (APL). The Veterinary Poisons Information Service, which runs the APL, reports that in around 80 per cent of the cases handled, a trip to the vet is not required. This, it says, saves the valuable time and resources of vet practices, as well as reducing emotional and financial stress for owners.

The APL is available 24 hours a day, 365 days a year, to provide advice and information for pet owners who telephone 01202 509000. It is a chargeable service with owners paying £35–£45 per case depending on the time of day.

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